

History and development

The creation of SSuite Office is overseen by South African based indie-developers. The suite claims to be the only freely available office suite that is not only oriented for best user experience but also not funded by any company. The team behind the creation of the product mainly consists of the van Loo brothers – both of whom have multiple degrees. Henk is an engineer with degrees in Mechanical, Electrical and Software, while Marius has degrees in Computer Science, Information Systems and Marketing.

The brothers were motivated to design and release their own versions of an effective office suite that would offer more features and tools than those generally available. In doing so, they decided to go beyond the limitations of what an office suite included. In their SSuite Office Excalibur Release, they've bundled a few other applications such as a set of general utilities that include an Address Book, Envelope Printer, Calendar, Notebook and System Overview besides the usual applications like 'WordGraph' (word processing) and 'Excel' (spreadsheets).

In the most practical sense, the SSuite Office suite is a personal experiment gone wild and with the continued work and generosity of the van Loo brothers has found a niche user base that not only admire its philosophy but also the efficiency it affords.

Working with SSuite Office

It's important to note that the Excalibur release of SSuite Office comes with many non-traditional office applications. The from-scratch design and development of the applications will overwhelm first time users a bit since the package has a significantly high learning curve. The approach taken by the developers is new and requires patience to make the most out of it.

The release also has a large number of different tools reaching almost 30 in number. There are tools such as email clients, instant messaging clients, image editing tools, networking tools, multimedia applications and music ripping tools. Being remarkably small and quick to operate on the Windows system, the installer files are designed to run on slower systems. This makes it a very suitable office suite for work environments where older systems that don't run as fast anymore are still used. The office suite is made purely on the Windows architecture with no plans to move to Android, Mac OS X and Linux.

In the attempt to place maximum control in the hands of the user the applications are designed to be highly customisable, which can be a hin-